The Haṭhayogasaṃhitā (17th Century): A Probable Precursor to the Gheraṇḍasaṃhitā

Translation of the Āsana Section

Introduction

In both academic and practical discussions, Haṭhayoga is traditionally associated with the “great three” texts: the Haṭhapradīpikā, Gheraṇḍasaṃhitā and Śivasaṃhitā. These works have long been treated as a comprehensive account of the yoga canon of the late medieval period. Recent philological research, however, shows that they form only part of a much larger manuscript tradition, many links of which remain little studied.

This article translates the section on āsanas from the rare Haṭhayogasaṃhitā. The translation is based on the Hindi edition published in Vārāṇasī by Śrī Bhārata Dharma Mahāmaṇḍala and edited by Yogirāja Svāmī Jñānānanda Ji Mahārāja. The text’s structure and content support the hypothesis that it represents a version of a work that likely served as a direct basis for the celebrated Gheraṇḍasaṃhitā.

The Missing Link: Jason Birch’s Research

A defining feature of later yoga, particularly the tradition of Gheraṇḍa, is the structure of Saptāṅgayoga, or seven-limbed yoga, in which practice begins with the purificatory actions (ṣaṭkarma) rather than with āsanas or yama and niyama. The origins of this system were previously not fully understood.

In “Haṭhayoga’s Floruit on the Eve of Colonialism” (2020), the Indologist and yoga historian Jason Birch discusses the seventeenth-century Haṭhayogasaṃhitā. According to Birch, the text predates the Gheraṇḍasaṃhitā and appears to have provided the basis for that influential compendium.

The following description is translated back into English from the Russian rendering in this article; it is not presented as a verbatim quotation of Birch’s English. For the original wording, see Birch, “Haṭhayoga’s Floruit on the Eve of Colonialism,” p. 458, note 17. Read Birch’s original chapter

The Haṭhayogasaṃhitā is a compilation that borrows extensively from the Haṭhapradīpikā. Its opening verses (1.2–3) acknowledge seven sages—Mārkaṇḍeya, Bharadvāja, Marīci, Jaimini, Parāśara, Bhṛgu and Viśvāmitra—for spreading Haṭhayoga throughout the world.

The stated aims of Haṭhayoga are purification (śodhanaṃ), firmness (dṛḍhatā), steadiness (sthairya), constancy (dhairya), lightness (lāghava), direct perception (pratyakṣa) and liberation (nirlipta) of the body (ghaṭa).

Its Haṭhayoga has seven auxiliary practices: ṣaṭkarma (six purificatory actions), āsana (posture), mudrā (seal), pratyāhāra (withdrawal of the senses), prāṇasaṃyāma (breath control), dhyāna (meditation) and samādhi (absorption).

The Haṭhayogasaṃhitā appears to have provided the basis for the eighteenth-century Gheraṇḍasaṃhitā, which adds a new frame narrative—a dialogue between the teacher Gheraṇḍa and the student Caṇḍakāpāli—along with several elaborate visualisation practices and a six-stage Rājayoga. The Gheraṇḍasaṃhitā calls its yoga ghaṭasthayoga, omits the Haṭhayogasaṃhitā's teaching on vajrolī and redefines this mudrā as a handstand, suggesting reluctance to adopt transgressive Haṭhayoga practices.

Textual Similarities and the Edition Used

The edition of Svāmī Jñānānanda Ji, which served as the source for this translation, shows significant structural similarities to Birch's description. The table of contents of the book strictly follows the logic of Saptāṅgayoga:

- Ṣaṭkarma - the text opens with a section on purification, which is a characteristic marker of this lineage (unlike Haṭhapradīpikā, which begins with āsanas).
- Āsana - follows and includes a classic set of poses.
- Mudra - section contains 25 mudras. It is important to note that the table of contents of this edition contains Vajrolī mudrā (item 11 in the list of mudras), which correlates with Birch's observation that the original Haṭhayogasaṃhitā contained this teaching before its modification in Gheraṇḍasaṃhitā.
- This is followed by the sections Pratyāhāra, Prāṇāyāma, Dhyāna and Samādhi.

The combination of these factors allows us to assume with a high degree of probability that the published translation gives the reader access to a text close to the "proto-version" of one of the most influential schools of yoga. This provides a unique opportunity to look at the formation of the canon of āsanas in the period preceding its final codification in the 18th century.

Organisation of the Translation

Below is the complete translation of the chapter on Āsanas (Āsana-prakaraṇa). To ensure accuracy and convenience for researchers, each verse is analyzed according to the following scheme:

- Original text in Sanskrit (Devanāgarī).
- Transliteration (IAST) and Cyrillic notation preserving vowel length.
- Word-by-word grammatical analysis.
- Literary translation of the verse.
- Translation of the Hindi commentary from the edition "Śrī Bhārata Dharma Mahāmaṇḍala", which clarifies the technical nuances of performing āsanas.

Chapter 2: Āsana-prakaraṇa — The Section on Postures

Verse 2.1 — Definition of Āsana

Sanskrit (Devanāgarī): अभ्यासाद्यस्य देहोऽयं योगौपयिकतां व्रजेत् । मनश्च स्थिरतामेति प्रोच्यते तदिहाऽऽसनम् ॥ १ ॥

Hindi commentary (corrected text): जिस तरह बैठने के अभ्यास से यह शरीर योगोपयोगी होता है और मन स्थिर होता है उसको आसन कहते हैं।

IAST: abhyāsādyasya deho'yaṃ yogaupayikatāṃ vrajet | manaśca sthiratāmeti procyate tadihā''sanam || 1 ||

Cyrillic transliteration: абхйāсāдйасйа дехо'йаṃ йогаупайикатāṃ враджет | манаш́ча стхиратāмети прочйате тадихā''санам || 1 ||

Word-by-word analysis: abhyāsāt — (abl. sg.) from practice; yasya — (gen. sg.) which; dehaḥ — (nom. sg.) body; ayam — (nom. sg.) this; yoga-aupayikatāṃ — (acc. sg.) fitness for yoga; vrajet — (opt. 3 sg.) can gain; manaḥ — (nom. sg.) mind; ca — And; sthiratām — (acc. sg.) stability; eti — (pres. 3 sg.) comes/reaches; procyate — (pass. pres. 3 sg.) is called; tat — That; iha — Here; āsanam — (nom. sg.) āsana.

Translation: “That by the practice of which the body becomes fit for yoga and the mind becomes stable is here called Āsana.”

English translation of the Hindi commentary: “The practice of sitting by which this body becomes useful for yoga and the mind becomes steady is called āsana.”

Verse 2.2 — The Number of Āsanas

Sanskrit (Devanāgarī): आसनानि समस्तानि यावत्यो जीवयोनयः । चतुरशीतिलक्षाणि शिवेन कथितानि तु ॥ २ ॥

Hindi commentary (corrected text): जितनी योनि के प्राणी हैं आसनों की संख्या भी उतनी ही जानना उचित है, देवादिदेव महादेव ने चौरासी लक्ष आसनों का वर्णन किया था।

IAST: āsanāni samastāni yāvatyo jīvayonayaḥ | caturaśītilakṣāṇi śivena kathitāni tu || 2 ||

Cyrillic transliteration: āсанāни самастāни йāватйо джӣвайонайаҳ | чатураш́ӣтилакшāṇи ш́ивена катхитāни ту || 2 ||

Word-by-word analysis: āsanāni samastāni — (nom. pl.) all āsanas; yāvatyaḥ — (nom. pl.) how much; jīva-yonayaḥ — species of living things; caturaśīti-lakṣāṇi — 84 lakh (8,400,000); śivena — (instr.) Śiva; kathitāni — (part.) told/described; tu — same.

Translation: “There are as many āsanas as there are types of living beings. Verily, 84 lakh (8,400,000) [āsanas] have been described by Śiva.”

English translation of the Hindi commentary: “As many types of living beings exist, the same number of āsanas should be known. 84 lakh āsanas have been described by the God of Gods Mahādeva.”

Verse 2.3 — The Most Important Āsanas

Sanskrit (Devanāgarī): तेषां मध्ये विशिष्टानि षोडशोनं शतं कृतम् । आसनानि त्रयस्त्रिंशन्मर्त्यलोके शुभानि वै ॥ ३ ॥

Hindi commentary (corrected text): उनमें से चौरासी आसन सबसे श्रेष्ठ हैं; और उन चौरासियों में से मानवलोक में तैतीस आसन कल्याण को देने वाले हैं।

IAST: teṣāṃ madhye viśiṣṭāni ṣoḍaśonaṃ śataṃ kṛtam | āsanāni trayastriṃśanmartyaloke śubhāni vai || 3 ||

Cyrillic transliteration: тешāṃ мадхйе виш́ишṭāни шодаш́онаṃ ш́атаṃ кṛтам | āсанāни трайастриṃш́анмартйалоке ш́убхāни ваи || 3 ||

Word-by-word analysis: teṣāṃ madhye — among them; viśiṣṭāni — (nom. pl.) outstanding/most important; ṣoḍaśa-ūnaṃ śataṃ — one hundred to sixteen (84); kṛtam — selected; āsanāni — āsanas; trayas-triṃśat — thirty three; martya-loke — in the mortal world; śubhāni — (nom. pl.) favorable; vai — true.

Translation: "Among them, eighty-four are considered the most important. [Of these] thirty-three āsanas are truly auspicious in the mortal world."

English translation of the Hindi commentary: "Among them, 84 āsanas are the best; and out of these 84 in the world of people, 33 āsanas bring good."

Verse 2.4-6 — The Place of Practice: The Maṭha

Sanskrit (Devanāgarī): सुराज्ये धार्मिके देशे सुभिक्षे निरुपद्रवे । धनुःप्रमाणपर्यन्तं शिलाग्निजलवर्जिते ॥ ४ ॥ एकान्ते मठिकामध्ये स्थातव्यं हठयोगिना ॥ ५ ॥ अल्पद्वारमरन्ध्रगर्तविवरं नात्युच्चनीचायतं सम्यग्गोमयसान्द्रलिप्तममलं निःशेषजन्तूज्झितम् । बाह्ये मण्डपवेदिकूपरुचिरं प्राकारसंवेष्टितं प्रोक्तं योगमठस्य लक्षणमिदं सिद्धैर्हठाभ्यासिभिः ॥ ६ ॥

Hindi commentary (corrected text): जहां सुराज्य हो, जो देश धार्मिक हो, जहां सुभिक्ष रहे, जिस देश में किसी प्रकार का उपद्रव न रहे वहां शिला, अग्नि और जल से धनुः प्रमाण परिमित दूर पर रहकर एकान्त स्थान में छोटी सी मठिका बनाकर योगी को योग साधन करना उचित है। योग साधन गृह में छोटा द्वार होना उचित है, वह घर छेद और बिल आदि से रहित हो, वह न तो बहुत ऊंचा हो और न बहुत नीचा, गोमय से लिपा हुआ हो, और सब प्रकार के कीटों से रहित हो तब ही वह साधन उपयोगी होगा। उस मठ के बाहर एक मण्डप, एक वेदी और एक कूप रहना उचित है। ऐसा वृक्ष आदि से रमणीय स्थान प्राकार द्वारा वेष्टित होने से वह योगाभ्यास के उपयोगी होता है और योगियों को सिद्धि दान कर सकता है।

IAST: surājye dhārmike deśe subhikṣe nirupadrave | dhanuḥpramāṇaparyantaṃ śilāgnijalavarjite || 4 || ekānte maṭhikāmadhye sthātavyaṃ haṭhayoginā || 5 || alpadvāramarandhragartavivaraṃ nātyuccanīcāyataṃ samyaggomayasāndraliptamamalaṃ niḥśeṣajantūjjhitam | bāhye maṇḍapavedikūparuciraṃ prākārasaṃveṣṭitaṃ proktaṃ yogamaṭhasya lakṣaṇamidaṃ siddhairhaṭhābhyāsibhiḥ || 6 ||

Cyrillic transliteration: сурāджйе дхāрмике деш́е субхикше нирупадраве | дхануҳпрамāṇапарйантаṃ ш́илāгниджалаварджите || 4 || екāнте маṭхикāмадхйе стхāтавйаṃ хаṭхайогинā || 5 || алпадвāрамарандхрагартавивараṃ нāтйуччанӣчāйатаṃ самйаггомайасāндралиптамамалаṃ ниҳш́ешаджантӯджджхитам | бāхйе маṇḍапаведикӯпаручираṃ прāкāрасаṃвешṭитаṃ проктаṃ йогамаṭхасйа лакшаṇамидаṃ сиддхаирхаṭхāбхйāсибхиҳ || 6 ||

Word-by-word analysis: su-rājye — in the good kingdom; dhārmike deśe — in a righteous country; su-bhikṣe — where is it easy to get food; nirupadrave — where there are no worries; dhanuḥ-pramāṇa-paryantaṃ — at a distance of a bow's length; śilā-agni-jala-varjite — free from stones, fire and water; ekānte — in solitude; maṭhikā-madhye — inside the hut; sthātavyaṃ — should stay; haṭha-yoginā — Haṭhayoga; alpa-dvāram — with a small door; arandhra-garta-vivaraṃ — without cracks, holes or cavities; na-ati-ucca-nīca-āyataṃ — not too high, not low and not too long; samyak-gomaya-sāndra-liptam — well coated with thick cow dung; amalaṃ — clean; niḥśeṣa-jantu-ujjhitam — free from all insects; bāhye — outside; maṇḍapa-vedi-kūpa-ruciraṃ — decorated with a canopy, altar and well; prākāra-saṃveṣṭitaṃ — surrounded by a wall/fence; proktaṃ —

described; yoga-maṭhasya lakṣaṇam — sign of a yogic abode; idam — This; siddhaiḥ — siddhas; haṭha-abhyāsibhiḥ — practicing Haṭhayoga.

Translation: “In a good kingdom, in a righteous country, where food is easy to obtain and there is no trouble. In a secluded place, free from stones, fire and dampness within a bow's length (around), a haṭhayogin should live in a small hut. [The hut should be] with a small door, without cracks, holes or cavities, not too high and not too low. It should be well coated with thick cow dung, clean and completely free from insects. Outside - it is decorated with a canopy, a raised platform (altar) and a well, and is surrounded by a fence. These are the signs of the yogic abode (maṭha) described by the siddhas who practice Haṭhayoga.”

English translation of the Hindi commentary: “Where there is good government, the country is religious, where there is an abundance of food and there is no disturbance - there, in a secluded place, at a distance of a bow's length from rocks, fire and water, a yogi should build a small hut and practice yoga. The house for yoga should have a small door, the house should be without holes and holes, not too high and not too low, covered with dung and free from all types of insects - only then is it suitable for practice. Outside this maṭha there should be a mandapa (canopy), vedi (altar) and a well. Such a place, pleasant because of trees and other things, surrounded by a wall, is beneficial for yogabhyasa and can bestow siddhis on yogis.”

Verse 2.7 — Beginning the Practice

Sanskrit (Devanāgarī): एवंविधे मठे स्थित्वा सर्वचिन्ताविवर्जितः । गुरूपदिष्टमार्गेण योगमेवं समभ्यसेत् ॥ ७ ॥

Hindi commentary (corrected text): इस प्रकार के मठ में स्थित होकर सब प्रकार की चिन्ताओं को त्याग करके गुरु उपदिष्ट साधन अनुसार अभ्यास करना मुमुक्षु को उचित है।

IAST: evamvidhe maṭhe sthitvā sarvacintāvivarjitaḥ | gurūpadiṣṭamārgeṇa yogamevaṃ samabhyaset || 7 ||

Cyrillic transliteration: евамвидхе маṭхе стхитвā сарвачинтāвиварджитаḥ | гурӯпадишṭамāргеṇа йогамеваṃ самабхйасет || 7 ||

Word-by-word analysis: evam-vidhe — in this kind; maṭhe — monastery; sthitvā — being; sarva-cintā-vivarjitaḥ — throwing away all worries; guru-upadiṣṭa-mārgeṇa — the path indicated by the guru; yogam — yoga; evam — So; samabhyaset — should be practiced.

Translation: “Being in such an abode, having given up all worries, one should practice yoga in the way prescribed by the Guru.”

English translation of the Hindi commentary: "Being in such a maṭha, abandoning all kinds of worries, the mumukṣu (seeker of liberation) should practice according to the method prescribed by the guru."

Verse 2.8-11 — The List of Āsanas

Sanskrit (Devanāgarī): सिद्धं च स्वस्तिकं पद्मं बद्धपद्मं च भद्रकम् । मुक्तं वज्रं च सिंहं च गोमुखं वीरमेव च ॥ ८ ॥ धनुर्मृतं तथा गुप्तं मात्स्यं मत्स्येन्द्रमेव च । गोरक्षं पश्चिमोत्तानमुत्कटं संकटं तथा ॥ ९ ॥ मायूरं कुक्कुटं कूर्मं तथा चोत्तानकूर्मकम् । उत्तानमण्डूकं वृक्षं मण्डूकं गरुडं वृषम् ॥ १० ॥ शलभं मकरं चोष्ट्रं भुजंगं योगमासनम् । आसनानि त्रयस्त्रिंशत् सिद्धिदानीति निश्चितम् ॥ ११ ॥

Hindi commentary (corrected text): [The Hindi names are listed here as identical to the Sanskrit names]... ये तैतीस मर्त्यलोक में सिद्धि देनेवाले हैं।

IAST: siddhaṃ ca svastikaṃ padmaṃ baddhapadmaṃ ca bhadrakam | muktaṃ vajraṃ ca siṃhaṃ ca gomukhaṃ vīrameva ca || 8 || dhanurmṛtaṃ tathā guptaṃ mātsyaṃ matsyendrameva ca | gorakṣaṃ paścimottānamutkaṭaṃ saṅkaṭaṃ tathā || 9 || māyūraṃ kukkuṭaṃ kūrmaṃ tathā cottānakūrmakam | uttānamaṇḍūkaṃ vṛkṣaṃ maṇḍūkaṃ garuḍaṃ vṛṣam || 10 || śalabhaṃ makaraṃ coṣṭraṃ bhujaṅgaṃ yogamāsanam | āsanāni trayastriṃśat siddhidānīti niścitam || 11 ||

Cyrillic transliteration: сиддхаṃ ча свастикаṃ падмаṃ баддхападмаṃ ча бхадракам | муктаṃ ваджраṃ ча симхаṃ ча гомукхаṃ вӣрамева ча || 8 || дханурмр̣таṃ татхā гуптаṃ мāтсйаṃ матсйендрамева ча | горакшаṃ паш́чимоттāнамуткат̣аṃ саṅкат̣аṃ татхā || 9 || мāйӯраṃ куккут̣аṃ кӯрмаṃ татхā чоттāнакӯрмакам | уттāнамаṇд̣ӯкаṃ вр̣кшаṃ маṇд̣ӯкаṃ гаруд̣аṃ вр̣шам || 10 || ш́алабхаṃ макараṃ чошт̣раṃ бхуджаṅгаṃ йогамāсанам | āсанāни трайастриṃш́ат сиддхидāнӣти ниш́читам || 11 ||

Word-by-word analysis: Names of the postures: Siddha, Svastika, Padma, Baddhapadma, Bhadra, Mukta, Vajra, Siṃha, Gomukha, Vīra, Dhanur, Mṛta, Gupta, Matsya, Matsyendra, Gorakṣa, Paścimottāna, Utkaṭa, Saṅkaṭa, Mayūra, Kukkuṭa, Kūrma, Uttānakūrma, Uttānamaṇḍūka, Vṛkṣa, Maṇḍūka, Garuḍa, Vṛṣa, Śalabha, Makara, Uṣṭra, Bhujaṅga and Yoga; āsanāni trayastriṃśat — thirty-three postures; siddhi-dāni — bestowing siddhis; iti niścitam — this is established.

Translation: [The list comprises:] Siddha, Svastika, Padma, Baddhapadma, Bhadra, Mukta, Vajra, Siṃha, Gomukha, Vīra, Dhanur, Mṛta, Gupta, Matsya, Matsyendra, Gorakṣa, Paścimottāna, Utkaṭa, Saṅkaṭa, Mayūra, Kukkuṭa, Kūrma, Uttānakūrma, Uttānamaṇḍūka, Vṛkṣa, Maṇḍūka, Garuḍa, Vṛṣa, Śalabha, Makara, Uṣṭra, Bhujaṅga and Yogāsana. These thirty-three āsanas are said to bestow perfection.

Verse 2.12-13 — Siddhāsana

Sanskrit (Devanāgarī): वशीकृतेन्द्रियग्रामो वामगुल्फेन गुह्यकम् । दक्षिणन च लिङ्गस्य मूलमापीडयेत्ततः ॥ १२ ॥ मेरुदण्डमृजुं कुर्वन्नास्यते यत्सुखासनम् । सिद्धासनमिति प्रोक्तं योगसिद्धिकरं परम् ॥ १३ ॥

Hindi commentary (corrected text): जितेन्द्रिय साधक जब वामगुल्फ द्वारा गुदा को दबाकर और दक्षिण गुल्फ द्वारा लिङ्ग मूल दबाकर मेरुदण्ड को सीधा करता हुआ सुख से बैठता है उसको सिद्धासन कहते हैं, यह योग सिद्धिकर है।

IAST: vaśīkṛtendriyagrāmo vāmagulphena guhyakam | dakṣiṇena ca liṅgasya mūlamāpīḍayettataḥ || 12 || merudaṇḍamṛjuṃ kurvannāsyate yatsukhāsanam | siddhāsanamiti proktaṃ yogasiddhikaraṃ param || 13 ||

Cyrillic transliteration: ваш́ӣкр̣тендрийагра̄мо вāмагулпхена гухйакам | дакшиṇена ча лиṅгасйа мӯламāпӣд̣айеттатах̣ || 12 || мерудаṇд̣амр̣джуṃ курваннāсйате йатсукхāсанам | сиддхāсанамити проктаṃ йогасиддхикараṃ парам || 13 ||

Word-by-word analysis: vaśīkṛta-indriya-grāmaḥ — (adj.) one who has subdued the aggregate of the senses; vāma-gulphena — (instr. sg.) left ankle; guhyakam — (acc. sg.) crotch; dakṣiṇena — (instr. sg.) right [ankle]; ca — And; liṅgasya mūlam — (acc. sg.) base of genitals; āpīḍayet — (opt. 3 sg.) should be pressed; tataḥ — then; merudaṇḍam — (acc. sg.) spinal column; ṛjuṃ — (acc. sg.) straight; kurvan — (pres. part.) doing; āsyate — (pass. pres. 3 sg.) sitting; yat — which; sukha-āsanam — (nom. sg.)

comfortable position; siddhāsanam — (nom. sg.) Siddhāsana; iti — So; proktaṃ — (part.) said; yoga-siddhi-karaṃ — bestowing perfection in yoga; param — (nom. sg.) higher.

Translation: “Controlling your senses, press the perineum with your left ankle and the base of the liṅga with your right. Having straightened the spine, sit comfortably - this is called Siddhāsana, which bestows the highest perfection in yoga.”

English translation of the Hindi commentary: “When a sādhaka (practitioner) who has conquered the senses, pressing his anus with his left ankle and the base of the liṅga with his right ankle, straightens his spine and sits comfortably, this is called Siddhāsana. It bestows the siddhi (perfection) of yoga.”

Verse 2.14 — Svastikāsana

Sanskrit (Devanāgarī): जानूर्वोरन्तरे कृत्वा सम्यक्पादतले उभे । ऋजुकायः समासीनः स्वस्तिकं तत्प्रचक्षते ॥ १४ ॥

Hindi commentary (corrected text): जानु द्वय और ऊरु युगल के बीच में चरण तल द्वय रखकर त्रिकोणाकार आसन बद्ध होकर सीधी रीति पर बैठने का नाम स्वस्तिकासन कहाता है।

IAST: jānūrvorantare kṛtvā samyakpādatale ubhe | ṛjukāyaḥ samāsīnaḥ svastikaṃ tatpracakṣate || 14 ||

Cyrillic transliteration: джānӯрворантаре кṛтвā самйакпāдатале убхе | ṛджукāйаḥ самāсӣнаḥ свастикаṃ татпрачакшате || 14 ||

Word-by-word analysis: jānu-ūrvouḥ — (gen. du.) knees and hips; antare — (loc. sg.) between/within; kṛtvā — (gerund) placing; samyak — properly; pāda-tale — (acc. du.) two soles of the feet; ubhe — (acc. du.) both; ṛju-kāyaḥ — (adj.) with straight body; samāsīnaḥ — (part.) sitting upright; svastikaṃ — (nom. sg.) Svastikāsana; tat — This; pracakṣate — (pres. 3 pl.) are called.

Translation: “Placing both the soles of the feet properly between the knees and thighs, sitting upright with the body straight is called Svastikāsana.”

English translation of the Hindi commentary: “By placing both the soles of the feet between the two knees and thighs, assuming a triangular posture and sitting upright, this is called by the name Svastikāsana.”

Verse 2.15 — Padmāsana

Sanskrit (Devanāgarī): दक्षिणं चरणं वामे दक्षिणोरौ च सव्यकम् । अक्लेशमासनं यद्धि पद्मासनमितीरितम् ॥ १५ ॥

Hindi commentary (corrected text): क्लेश रहित होकर बैठते हुए दक्षिण पैर वाम ऊरु के ऊपर और वाम पैर दक्षिण ऊरु के ऊपर रख कर जो सुगम आसन होता है उसको पद्मासन कहते हैं।

IAST: dakṣiṇaṃ caraṇaṃ vāme dakṣiṇorau ca savyakam | akleśamāsanaṃ yaddhi padmāsanamitīritam || 15 ||

Cyrillic transliteration: дакшиṇаṃ чараṇаṃ вāме дакшиṇорау ча савйакам | аклеш́амāсанаṃ йаддхи падмāсанамитӣритам || 15 ||

Word-by-word analysis: dakṣiṇaṃ caraṇaṃ — (acc. sg.) right foot; vāme — (loc. sg.) on left [thigh]; dakṣiṇa-ūrau — (loc. sg.) on the right thigh; ca — And; savyakam — (acc. sg.) left; akleśam — (adj.) without torment/pain; āsanaṃ — pose; yat — which; hi — really; padmāsanam — Padmāsana; iti īritam — that's what it says.

Translation: “[Placing] the right foot on the left [thigh] and the left foot on the right thigh. A pose [performed] without pain is truly called Padmāsana.”

English translation of the Hindi commentary: “Sitting without tension, placing the right leg on the left thigh and the left leg on the right thigh - such an easy pose is called Padmāsana.”

Verse 2.16 — Baddhapadmāsana

Sanskrit (Devanāgarī): वामोरूपरि दक्षिणं हि चरणं संस्थाप्य वामं तथा दक्षोरूपरि पश्चिमेन विधिना धृत्वा कराभ्यां दृढम् । अङ्गुष्ठौ हृदये निधाय चिबुकं नासाग्रमालोकये- देतद्व्याधिविनाशनं सुखकरं बद्धपद्मासनं प्रोच्यते ॥ १६ ॥

Hindi commentary (corrected text): दक्षिण पाद वाम उरु के ऊपर और वाम पाद दक्षिण ऊरु के ऊपर स्थापन करके करद्वय द्वारा पीठ से घुमाकर चरणों के अंगूठे धारण करके चिबुक वक्षस्थल पर स्थापन करके नासाग्रभाग दर्शन करने से बद्ध पद्मासन हुआ करता है, इस आसन द्वारा नाना प्रकार की व्याधियों का नाश होता है।

IAST: vāmorūpari dakṣiṇaṃ hi caraṇaṃ saṃsthāpya vāmaṃ tathā dakṣorūpari paścimena vidhinā dhṛtvā karābhyāṃ dṛḍham | aṅguṣṭhau hṛdaye nidhāya cibukaṃ nāsāgramālokaye- detadvyādhivināśanaṃ sukhakaraṃ baddhapadmāsanaṃ procyate || 16 ||

Cyrillic transliteration: вāморӯпари дакшиṇаṃ хи чараṇаṃ саṃстхāпйа вāмаṃ татхā дакшорӯпари паш́чимена видхинā дхр̣твā карāбхйāṃ др̣дхам | аṅгушт̣хау хр̣дайе нидхāйа чибукаṃ нāсāграмāлокайе- детадвйāдхивинāш́анаṃ сукхакараṃ баддхападмāсанаṃ прочйате || 16 ||

Word-by-word analysis: vāma-ūru-upari — on the left thigh; dakṣiṇaṃ hi caraṇaṃ — right foot; saṃsthāpya — (gerund) having placed; vāmaṃ — left; tathā — Also; dakṣa-ūru-upari — on the right thigh; paścimena vidhinā — back method; dhṛtvā — capturing; karābhyāṃ — (instr. du.) hands; dṛḍham — tightly; aṅguṣṭhau — (acc. du.) two big toes; hṛdaye — (loc. sg.) on the heart (chest); nidhāya — (gerund) putting; cibukaṃ — (acc. sg.) chin; nāsā-agram — tip of the nose; ālokayet — should be contemplated; etat — This; vyādhi-vināśanaṃ — destroying diseases; sukha-karaṃ — bringing happiness; baddha-padmāsanaṃ — Baddhapadmāsana; procyate — called.

Translation: “Placing the right foot on the left thigh and the left foot on the right, firmly grasping the big toes with the hands [crossed] from behind; placing the chin on the chest and looking at the tip of the nose - this is called Baddhapadmāsana, destroying diseases and giving happiness.”

English translation of the Hindi commentary: “By placing the right foot on the left thigh and the left on the right, placing both hands behind the back and grasping the big toes, pressing the chin to the chest and looking at the tip of the nose, Baddhapadmāsana is performed. Thanks to this āsana, various types of diseases are destroyed.”

Verse 2.17-18 — Bhadrāsana

Sanskrit (Devanāgarī): गुल्फौ च वृषणस्याधो व्युत्क्रमेण समाहितौ । पादाङ्गुष्ठौ कराभ्यां च धृत्वा च पृष्ठदेशतः ॥ १७ ॥ जालन्धरं समासाद्य नासाग्रमवलोकयेत् । भद्रासनं भवेदेतत् सर्वव्याधिविनाशनम् ॥ १८ ॥

Hindi commentary (corrected text): दोनों गुल्फ वृषण के नीचे विपरीत भाव से स्थापन करके पृष्ठ से करद्वय चलाकर दोनों चरणों के अंगूठे धारणपूर्वक जालन्धर बन्ध करते हुए नासिका के अग्रभाग का दर्शन करने से भद्रासन हुआ करता है। इस आसन के अभ्यास से सब प्रकार की व्याधियों की शान्ति हुआ करती है।

IAST: gulphau ca vṛṣaṇasyādho vyutkrameṇa samāhitau | pādāṅguṣṭhau karābhyāṃ ca dhṛtvā ca pṛṣṭhadeśataḥ || 17 || jālandharaṃ samāsādya nāsāgramavalokayet | bhadrāsanaṃ bhavedetat sarvavyādhivināśanam || 18 ||

Cyrillic transliteration: гулпхау ча вр̣шаṇасйādхо вйуткрамеṇа самāхитау | пāдāṅгушт̣хау карāбхйāṃ ча дхр̣твā ча пр̣шт̣хадеш́атаḥ || 17 || джāландхараṃ самāсāдйа нāсāграмавалокайет | бхадрāсанаṃ бхаведетат сарвавйāдхивинāш́анам || 18 ||

Word-by-word analysis: gulphau — (acc. du.) two ankles; ca — And; vṛṣaṇasya adhaḥ — under the perineum/scrotum; vyutkrameṇa — (instr.) cross/reverse order; samāhitau — (part.) connected; pāda-aṅguṣṭhau — (acc. du.) big toes; karābhyāṃ — hands; dhṛtvā — holding; pṛṣṭha-deśataḥ — from the back (with your arms back); jālandharaṃ — Jālandhara [bandha]; samāsādya — having completed; nāsā-agram — tip of the nose; avalokayet — should watch; bhadrāsanaṃ — Bhadrāsana; bhavet — becomes; etat — This; sarva-vyādhi-vināśanam — destroying all diseases.

Translation: “By carefully placing the ankles crosswise under the perineum, and holding the big toes with the hands behind the back, performing Jālandhara [bandha] and looking at the tip of the nose, this becomes Bhadrāsana, destroying all diseases.”

English translation of the Hindi commentary: “By placing both ankles under the scrotum in a cross manner, placing the hands behind the back and holding the big toes, performing Jālandhara bandha and looking at the tip of the nose, Bhadrāsana is obtained. By the practice of this āsana all types of diseases are calmed.”

Verse 2.19 — Muktāsana

Sanskrit (Devanāgarī): पायुमूले वामगुल्फं दक्षगुल्फं तथोपरि । समकायशिरोग्रीवं मुक्तासनं तु सिद्धिदम् ॥ १९ ॥

Hindi commentary (corrected text): पायुमूल में वामगुल्फ रखकर उसके ऊपर दक्षिणगुल्फ स्थापित करके मस्तक और ग्रीवा सीध में रखते हुए शरीर को समभाव में रखने से मुक्तासन हुआ करता है, यह आसन साधकगण को सिद्धि का देनेवाला है।

IAST: pāyumūle vāmagulphaṃ dakṣagulphaṃ tathopari | samakāyaśirogrīvaṃ muktāsanaṃ tu siddhidam || 19 ||

Cyrillic transliteration: пāйумӯле вāмагулпхаṃ дакшагулпхаṃ татхопари | самакāйаш́ирогрӣваṃ мукт̣āсанаṃ ту сиддхидам || 19 ||

Word-by-word analysis: pāyu-mūle — (loc. sg.) at the base of the anus; vāma-gulphaṃ — (acc. sg.) left ankle; dakṣa-gulphaṃ — (acc. sg.) right ankle; tathā upari — and also on top; sama-kāya-śiro-grīvaṃ — (adj.) holding the body, head and neck straight; muktāsanaṃ — Muktāsana; tu — same; siddhi-dam — giving perfection.

Translation: "[Placing] the left ankle at the base of the anus and the right ankle on top of it, keeping the body, head and neck in one line - this is Muktāsana, which bestows siddhi."

English translation of the Hindi commentary: “By placing the left ankle at the base of the anus, placing the right ankle on top of it, keeping the head and neck straight and keeping the body balanced, Muktāsana is performed. This āsana bestows siddhi on the practitioner.”

Verse 2.20 — Vajrāsana

Sanskrit (Devanāgarī): जङ्घाभ्यां वज्रवत्कृत्वा गुदपार्श्वे पदावुभौ । वज्रासनं भवेदेतद्योगिनां सिद्धिदायकम् ॥ २० ॥

Hindi commentary (corrected text): दोनों जंघाओं को वज्राकृति करके गुदा के उभय पार्श्व में दोनों पैरों को स्थापन करने से वज्रासन हुआ करता है। यह आसन योगियों को सिद्धि प्रदान करने वाला है।

IAST: jaṅghābhyāṃ vajravatkṛtvā gudapārśve padāvubhau | vajrāsanaṃ bhavedetadyoginām siddhidāyakam || 20 ||

Cyrillic transliteration: джаṅгхābхйāṃ ваджраваткṛтвā гудапāрш́ве падāвубхау | ваджрāсанаṃ бхаведетадйогинāṃ сиддхидāйакам || 20 ||

Word-by-word analysis: jaṅghābhyāṃ — (instr. du.) shins/hips; vajravat — like a diamond/hard; kṛtvā — having done; guda-pārśve — (loc. sg.) on the sides of the anus; padau ubhau — (acc. du.) both feet; vajrāsanaṃ — Vajrāsana; bhavet etat — it becomes; yoginām — (gen. pl.) for yogis; siddhi-dāyakam — giving success.

Translation: "By making the shins as hard as diamonds (or placing them firmly), placing both feet on either side of the anus, this becomes Vajrāsana, which bestows success on the yogis."

English translation of the Hindi commentary: "By making both legs like a vajra (hard/folded) and placing both feet on either side of the anus, Vajrāsana is performed. This āsana bestows siddhi on yogis."

Verse 2.21-22 — Siṃhāsana

Sanskrit (Devanāgarī): गुल्फौ च वृषणस्याधो व्युत्क्रमेणोर्ध्वगौ । चितिमूलौ भूमिसंस्थौ कृत्वा च जानुनोपरि ॥ २१ ॥ व्यक्तवक्त्रो जालन्धरं च नासाग्रमवलोकयेत् । सिंहासनं भवेदेतत् सर्वव्याधिविनाशनम् ॥ २२ ॥

Hindi commentary (corrected text): गुल्फद्वय वृषण के नीचे उलटी रीति से रखकर ऊपर की ओर निकलते हुए, दोनों जानुओं को पृथ्वी पर रखकर और जानुओं के ऊपर मुख व्यक्त रीति पर रखके जालन्धर बन्ध करते हुए नासिका के अग्रभाग को देखने से सिंहासन हुआ करता है। इस आसन के साधन से सब प्रकार की व्याधियों की शान्ति हुआ करती है।

IAST: gulphau ca vṛṣaṇasyādho vyutkrameṇordhvagau | kṣitimūlau bhūmisaṃsthau kṛtvā ca jānunopari || 21 || vyaktavaktro jālandharaṃ ca nāsāgramavalokayet | siṃhāsanaṃ bhavedetat sarvavyādhivināśanam || 22 ||

Cyrillic transliteration: гулпхау ча вр̣шаṇасйādхо вйуткрамеṇордхвагау | кшитимӯлау бхӯмисаṃстхау кр̣твā ча джāнунопари || 21 || вйактавактро джāландхараṃ ча нāсāграмавалокайет | сиṃхāсанаṃ бхаведетат сарвавйādхивинāш́анам || 22 ||

Word-by-word analysis: gulphau — (acc. du.) two ankles; ca — And; vṛṣaṇasya adhaḥ — under the scrotum; vyutkrameṇa — crosswise; ūrdhva-gau — (acc. du.) directed upward; kṣiti-mūlau — (acc. du.) with the bases (palms/knees) to the ground; bhūmi-saṃsthau — placed on the ground; kṛtvā — having done; ca — And; jānunā upari — over the knees (arms); vyakta-vaktraḥ — (nom. sg.) with open mouth; jālandharaṃ — Jālandhara bandhu; ca — And; nāsā-agram — on the tip of the nose; avalokayet — should watch; siṃhāsanaṃ — Siṃhāsana; bhavet etat — it becomes; sarva-vyādhi-vināśanam — destroying all diseases.

Translation: “Place your ankles crosswise under your perineum, pointing upward; placing the knees (or palms) on the ground, and [the hands] on top of the knees; performing Jālandhara bandha with an open mouth and looking at the tip of the nose - this becomes Siṃhāsana, destroying all diseases.”

English translation of the Hindi commentary: “By placing both ankles under the scrotum in a cross manner so that they point upward, placing both knees on the ground, keeping the mouth wide open, performing Jālandhara bandha and looking at the tip of the nose, this is Siṃhāsana. By the practice of this āsana all types of diseases are calmed.”

Verse 2.23 — Gomukhāsana

Sanskrit (Devanāgarī): पादौ च भूमौ संस्थाप्य पृष्ठपार्श्वे निवेशयेत् । स्थिरकायं समासाद्य गोमुखं गोमुखाकृतिः ॥ २३ ॥

Hindi commentary (corrected text): पृथिवी के ऊपर दोनों चरणों को स्थापन करके पीठ के दोनों ओर निकालते हुए गोमुख की नाई आसन करके समान होकर बैठने से गोमुखासन कहाता है।

IAST: pādau ca bhūmau saṃsthāpya pṛṣṭhapārśve niveśayet | sthirakāyaṃ samāsādya gomukhaṃ gomukhākṛtiḥ || 23 ||

Cyrillic transliteration: пāдау ча бхӯмау саṃстхāпйа пр̣шт̣хапāрш́ве нивеш́айет | стхиракāйаṃ самāсāдйа гомукхаṃ гомукхāкр̣тих̣ || 23 ||

Word-by-word analysis: pādau — (acc. du.) two feet; ca — And; bhūmau — (loc. sg.) on the ground; saṃsthāpya — (gerund) having placed; pṛṣṭha-pārśve — (loc. sg.) on the sides of the back (pelvis); niveśayet — (opt.) should be placed; sthira-kāyaṃ — (acc. sg.) stable body; samāsādya — (gerund) having reached/accepted; gomukhaṃ — (nom. sg.) Gomukhāsana; gomukha-ākṛtiḥ — (adj.) shaped like a cow's muzzle.

Translation: “By planting the feet on the ground and placing them on the sides of the back (buttocks), making the body stable - this is Gomukhāsana, shaped like a cow’s face.”

English translation of the Hindi commentary: “Placing both feet on the ground and extending them on either side of the back, assuming a posture like a cow’s face and sitting upright is called Gomukhāsana.”

Verse 2.24 — Vīrāsana

Sanskrit (Devanāgarī): एकं पादमथैकस्मिन् विन्यसेदुरुसन्निधौ । इतरं तु तथा पश्चाद्वीरासनमितीरितम् ॥ २४ ॥

Hindi commentary (corrected text): एक ऊरु के पास एक पाद रखकर दूसरे पाद को पीछे की ओर रखने से वीरासन कहलाता है।

IAST: ekaṃ pādamathaikasmin vinyasedurusannidhau | itaraṃ tu tathā paścādvīrāsanamitīritam || 24 ||

Cyrillic transliteration: екаṃ пāдаматхаикасмин винйаседурусаннидхау | итараṃ ту татхā паш́чāдвӣрāсанамитӣритам || 24 ||

Word-by-word analysis: ekam pādam — (acc. sg.) one foot; atha — then; ekasmin — (loc. sg.) on one [side/ground]; vinyaset — (opt.) should be placed; uru-sannidhau — (loc. sg.) near the thigh; itaram — (acc. sg.) another; tu — same; tathā — So; paścāt — behind; vīrāsanam — Vīrāsana; iti īritam — that's what it says.

Translation: “Then one foot should be placed near [one] thigh and the other behind. This is called Vīrāsana (Hero Pose).”

English translation of the Hindi commentary: “Placing one foot near one thigh and moving the other leg back is called Vīrāsana.”

Verse 2.25 — Dhanurāsana

Sanskrit (Devanāgarī): प्रसार्य पादौ भुवि दण्डरूपौ करौ च पृष्ठे धृतपादयुग्मौ । कृत्वा धनुस्तुल्यविवर्त्तिताङ्गं निगद्यते वै धनुरासनं तत् ॥ २५ ॥

Hindi commentary (corrected text): दोनों चरणों को पृथिवी पर दण्डवत् सीधा रखकर पीठ की ओर से दोनों हाथ चलाकर चरण युगल को धारण करके देह को धनुष आकार करने से उसे योगीगण धनुरासन कहते हैं।

IAST: prasārya pādau bhuvi daṇḍarūpau karau ca pṛṣṭhe dhṛtapādayugmau | kṛtvā dhanustulyavivarttitāṅgaṃ nigadyate vai dhanurāsanaṃ tat || 25 ||

Cyrillic transliteration: прасāрйа пāдау бхуви даṇдарӯпау карау ча пр̣шт̣хе дхр̣тапāдайугмау | кр̣твā дханустулйавиварттитāṅгаṃ нигадйате ваи дханурāсанаṃ тат || 25 ||

Word-by-word analysis: prasārya — (gerund) stretching out; pādau — (acc. du.) feet/legs; bhuvi — (loc. sg.) on the ground; daṇḍa-rūpau — (adj.) like a stick; karau — (acc. du.) hands; ca — And; pṛṣṭhe — (loc. sg.) behind the back (from the back); dhṛta-pāda-yugmau — (adj.) holding a pair of feet; kṛtvā — (gerund) having done; dhanus-tulya — like a bow; vivarttita-aṅgaṃ — (adj.) curved body; nigadyate — (pass.) is called; vai — true; dhanurāsanaṃ — Dhanurāsana; tat — This.

Translation: “Stretching your legs on the ground like a stick, grasping both feet with your hands from the back and making the body curved like a bow is truly called Dhanurāsana.”

English translation of the Hindi commentary: “By extending both legs on the ground straight like sticks, bringing both hands from the side of the back and grasping a pair of feet, giving the body a bow shape - yogis call this Dhanurāsana.”

Verse 2.26 — Mṛtāsana / Śavāsana

Sanskrit (Devanāgarī): उत्तानं शववद्भूमौ शयानं तु शवासनम् । शवासनं श्रमहरं चित्तविश्रान्तिकारणम् ॥ २६ ॥

Hindi commentary (corrected text): मृत मनुष्य की नाई पृथिवी पर शयन करने से मृतासन कहाता है, इसका नाम शवासन है। यह आसन श्रम को दूर करने वाला और चित्त विश्राम का हेतु कहाता है।

IAST: uttānaṃ śavavadbhūmau śayānaṃ tu śavāsanam | śavāsanaṃ śramaharaṃ cittaviśrāntikāraṇam || 26 ||

Cyrillic transliteration: уттāнаṃ ш́ававадбхӯмау ш́айāнаṃ ту ш́авāсанам | ш́авāсанаṃ ш́рамахараṃ читтавиш́рāнтикāраṇам || 26 ||

Word-by-word analysis: uttānaṃ — (adv.) face up/on back; śava-vat — like a corpse; bhūmau — (loc. sg.) on the ground; śayānaṃ — lying; tu — same; śavāsanam — (nom. sg.) Śavāsana; śrama-haraṃ — (adj.) eliminating fatigue; citta-viśrānti-kāraṇam — the cause (means) of peace of mind.

Translation: “Lying on the ground face up, like a corpse, is Śavāsana. Śavāsana eliminates fatigue and gives peace to the mind.”

English translation of the Hindi commentary: “Lying on the ground like a dead person is called Mṛtāsana, another name is Śavāsana. This āsana eliminates fatigue and is called the cause of rest of the mind (citta).”

Verse 2.27 — Guptāsana

Sanskrit (Devanāgarī): जानूर्वोरन्तरे पादौ कृत्वा पादौ च गोपयेत् । पादोपरि च संस्थाप्य गुदं गुप्तासनं विदुः ॥ २७ ॥

Hindi commentary (corrected text): जानु द्वय के मध्यस्थल में चरण युगल को गुप्त भाव से स्थापन करके उन चरणों पर गुह्यदेश रखने से गुप्तासन कहाता है।

IAST: jānūrvorantare pādau kṛtvā pādau ca gopayet | pādopari ca saṃsthāpya gudaṃ guptāsanaṃ viduḥ || 27 ||

Cyrillic transliteration: джа̄нӯрворантаре па̄дау кр̣тва̄ па̄дау ча гопайет | па̄допари ча саṃстха̄пйа гудаṃ гупта̄санаṃ видух̣ || 27 ||

Word-by-word analysis: jānu-ūrvouḥ antare — between the knees and thighs; pādau — (acc. du.) feet; kṛtvā — (gerund) placing; pādau — feet; ca — And; gopayet — (opt.) should be hidden; pāda-upari — on top of the feet; ca — And; saṃsthāpya — (gerund) having placed; gudaṃ — (acc. sg.) anus; guptāsanaṃ — Guptāsana; viduḥ — (perf. 3 pl.) know/believe.

Translation: “By placing your feet between your knees and thighs, you should hide your feet. By placing the anus on top of the feet, [the sages] know this as Guptāsana.”

English translation of the Hindi commentary: “Hiddenly placing a pair of feet in the space between two knees and placing the anus (guhya-desh) on these feet is called Guptāsana.”

Verse 2.28 — Matsyāsana

Sanskrit (Devanāgarī): मुक्तपद्मासनं कृत्वा उत्तानशयनं चरेत् । कूर्पराभ्यां शिरो वेष्ट्य मत्स्यासनमरोगकृत् ॥ २८ ॥

Hindi commentary (corrected text): मुक्त पद्मासन करके कोहनियों को शिर पर लगा कर शयन करने से मत्स्यासन हुआ करती है। इस आसन द्वारा नाना प्रकार के रोगों की शान्ति हुआ करती है।

IAST: muktapadmāsanaṃ kṛtvā uttānaśayanaṃ caret | kūrparābhyāṃ śiro veṣṭya matsyāsanamarogakṛt || 28 ||

Cyrillic transliteration: мукта̄падма̄санаṃ кр̣тва̄ уттана́йанаṃ чарет | кӯрпара̄бхйа̄ṃ ш́иро вешт̣йа матсйа̄санамарогакр̣т || 28 ||

Word-by-word analysis: mukta-padmāsanaṃ — (acc. sg.) free Padmāsana (without crossing arms); kṛtvā — (gerund) having done; uttāna-śayanaṃ — (acc. sg.) lying face up; caret — (opt.) should be done; kūrparābhyāṃ — (instr. du.) elbows; śiro — (acc. sg.) head; veṣṭya — (gerund) surrounding/enveloping; matsyāsanam — Matsyāsana; aroga-kṛt — destroying diseases.

Translation: “After performing free Padmāsana (without grasping your feet with your hands), you should lie on your back. Covering the head with the elbows is Matsyāsana, which relieves diseases.”

English translation of the Hindi commentary: “By making a free Padmāsana and placing your elbows on your head (embracing it), lying on your back, Matsyāsana is performed. With the help of this āsana, various types of diseases are calmed.”

Verse 2.29-30 — Matsyendrāsana

Sanskrit (Devanāgarī): उदरं पश्चिमाभासं कृत्वा तिष्ठति यत्नतः । नम्राङ्गं वामपादं च दक्षजानूपरि न्यसेत् ॥ २९ ॥ तत्र याम्यं कूर्परं च करे याम्ये च वक्त्रकम् । भ्रुवोर्मध्ये गता दृष्टिः पीठं मात्स्येन्द्रमुच्यते ॥ ३० ॥

Hindi commentary (corrected text): जठर देश पीठ की नाई ऋजुभाव से स्थापन करके यत्न पूर्वक स्थिर रहकर वामपाद को नम्र करके दक्षिण जानु के ऊपर रखकर और उस पर दक्षिण कोहनी को रखकर दक्षिण हाथ पर वदन रक्खे हुए भ्रूयुगल के बीच में दर्शन करने से मत्स्येन्द्रासन हुआ करता है।

IAST: udaraṃ paścimābhāsaṃ kṛtvā tiṣṭhati yatnataḥ | namrāṅgaṃ vāmapādaṃ ca dakṣajānūpari nyaset || 29 || tatra yāmyaṃ kūrparaṃ ca kare yāmye ca vaktrakam | bhruvormadhye gatā dṛṣṭiḥ pīṭhaṃ mātsyendramucyate || 30 ||

Cyrillic transliteration: удараṃ паш́чимāбхāсаṃ кр̣твā тишт̣хати йатнатаḥ | намрāṅгаṃ вāмапāдаṃ ча дакшаджāнӯпари нйасет || 29 || татра йāмйаṃ кӯрпараṃ ча каре йāмйе ча вактракам | бхрувормадхйе гатā др̣шт̣иḥ пīт̣хаṃ мāтсйендрамучйате || 30 ||

Word-by-word analysis: udaraṃ — (acc. sg.) belly; paścima-ābhāsaṃ — backward-facing (retracted toward the back or twisted); kṛtvā — having done; tiṣṭhati — (pres. 3 sg.) stands/is; yatnataḥ — with effort / diligently; namra-aṅgaṃ — (acc. sg.) bent limb; vāma-pādaṃ — (acc. sg.) left leg; ca — And; dakṣa-jānu-upari — on the right knee; nyaset — (opt.) should be placed; tatra — there; yāmyaṃ kūrparaṃ — (acc. sg.) right elbow; ca — And; kare yāmye — (loc. sg.) in the right hand/palm; ca — And; vaktrakam — (acc. sg.) face; bhruvoḥ madhye — between the eyebrows; gatā dṛṣṭiḥ — fixed gaze; pīṭhaṃ mātsyendram — Matsyendra pose; ucyate — (pass.) is called.

Translation: “With your stomach drawn in towards your back (or twisted backwards), you should stand diligently. Place the bent left leg on the right knee. There [place] the right elbow, and the face in the right hand, the gaze is directed between the eyebrows - this is called the Matsyendra pose.”

English translation of the Hindi commentary: “By placing the abdominal area straight (or twisted) like the back, diligently remaining stable, bending the left leg and placing it on the right knee, placing the right elbow on it and resting the face on the right hand, looking between the eyebrows, Matsyendrāsana is performed.”

Verse 2.31-32 — Gorakṣāsana

Sanskrit (Devanāgarī): जानूर्वोरन्तरे पादावुत्तानी व्यक्तसंस्थितौ । गुल्फौ चाच्छाद्य हस्ताभ्यामुत्तानाभ्यां प्रयत्नतः ॥ ३१ ॥ कण्ठसङ्कोचनं कृत्वा नासाग्रमवलोकयेत् । गोरक्षासनमित्याहुर्योगिनां सिद्धिकारणम् ॥ ३२ ॥

Hindi commentary (corrected text): जानु द्वय और ऊरु के बीच में पद युगल को व्यक्त भाव से उत्तान रूप से स्थापन करके उत्तान करद्वय द्वारा गुल्फ युगल को समावृत किया जाय। तदनन्तर कण्ठसंकोचन पूर्वक नासिका के अग्रभाग दर्शन करने से गोरक्षासन होता है, यह आसन योगियों को सिद्धि देनेवाला है।

IAST: jānūrvorantare pādāvuttānau vyaktasaṃsthitau | gulphau cācchādya hastābhyāmuttānābhyāṃ prayatnataḥ || 31 || kaṇṭhasaṅkocanaṃ kṛtvā nāsāgramavalokayet | gorakṣāsanamityāhuryoginām siddhikāraṇam || 32 ||

Cyrillic transliteration: джāнӯрворантаре пāдāвуттāнау вйактасаṃстхитау | гулпхау чāччхāдйа хастāбхйāмуттāнāбхйāṃ прайатнатаḥ || 31 || каṇт̣хасаṅкочанаṃ кр̣твā нāсāграмавалокайет | горакшāсанамитйāхурйогинāṃ сиддхикāраṇам || 32 ||

Word-by-word analysis: jānu-ūrvouḥ antare — (loc. sg.) between the knees and thighs; pādau uttānau — (acc. du.) two feet facing up; vyakta-saṃsthitau — (acc. du.) clearly/openly located; gulphau — (acc. du.) ankles/heels; ca — And; ācchādya — (gerund) covering/grasping; hastābhyām — (instr. du.) hands; uttānābhyāṃ — (instr. du.) facing up/extended; prayatnataḥ — with effort / diligently; kaṇṭha-saṅkocanaṃ kṛtvā — performing throat compression (Jālandhara bandha); nāsā-agram — on the tip of the nose; avalokayet — should watch; gorakṣāsanam — Gorakṣāsana; iti āhuḥ — that's what they call it; yogināṃ — for yogis; siddhi-kāraṇam — the cause (means) of perfection.

Translation: "Placing both feet, with the soles facing upward, open between the knees and thighs; and carefully covering his ankles with his unfolded hands; by constricting the throat (Jālandhara bandha) and looking at the tip of the nose - this is called Gorakṣāsana, the cause of perfection for yogis."

English translation of the Hindi commentary: "Having clearly and openly placed a pair of feet, soles up, between the knees and thighs, one should grasp the ankles with open hands. Then, squeezing the throat and looking at the tip of the nose, Gorakṣāsana is performed; this āsana gives siddhi to yogis."

Verse 2.33 — Paścimottānāsana / Ugrāsana

Sanskrit (Devanāgarī): प्रसार्य पादौ भुवि दण्डरूपौ संन्यस्य भालं चितियुग्ममध्ये । यत्नेन पादौ विधृतौ कराभ्या- मुत्तानपश्चासनमेतदाहुः ॥ ३३ ॥

Note on Sanskrit: The text uses the term "चिति" (chiti - earth/foundation/fire), but in the context of yogic texts it is usually "जानु" (knee). Hindi comment confirms "between the thighs/knees".

Hindi commentary (corrected text): पदयुगल को पृथिवी पर दण्डवत् सीधे रखकर करद्वय द्वारा यत्न पूर्वक चरणद्वय को धारण करके जंघाओं के बीच में शिर रखने से पश्चिमोत्तान आसन कहाता है। इस आसन में वायु का उद्दीपन होता है इस कारण इसको उग्रासन भी कहते हैं।

IAST: prasārya pādau bhuvi daṇḍarūpau saṃnyasya bhālaṃ citiyugmamadhye | yatnena pādau vidhṛtau karābhyā- muttānapaścāsanametadāhuḥ || 33 ||

Cyrillic transliteration: прасāрйа пāдау бхуви даṇдарӯпау саṃнйасйа бхāлаṃ читийугмамадхйе | йатнена пāдау видхр̣тау карāбхйā- муттāнапаш́чāсанаметадāхух̣ || 33 ||

Word-by-word analysis: prasārya — pulling out; pādau — feet; bhuvi — on the ground; daṇḍa-rūpau — like a stick; saṃnyasya — putting; bhālaṃ — forehead; citi-yugma-madhye — between a pair of knees (legs); yatnena — diligently; pādau vidhṛtau — feet held; karābhyām — hands; uttāna-paśca-āsanam — (Paścimottānāsana) stretching pose for the back of the body; etat — This; āhuḥ — called.

Translation: "Stretching the legs on the ground like a stick, placing the forehead between the knees and carefully holding the feet with the hands is called Paścimottānāsana."

English translation of the Hindi commentary: "Placing a pair of feet directly on the ground, like a stick, carefully grasping the feet with the hands and placing the head between the thighs (legs) is called Paścimottānāsana. In this āsana, vāyu (fire/prana) is kindled, therefore it is also called Ugrāsana."

Verse 2.34 — Utkaṭāsana

Sanskrit (Devanāgarī): अङ्गुष्ठाभ्यामवष्टभ्य धरां गुल्फौ च खे गतौ । तत्रोपरि गुदं न्यस्य विज्ञेयमुत्कटासनम् ॥ ३४ ॥

Hindi commentary (corrected text): पदाङ्गुष्ठ द्वय द्वारा मृत्तिका स्पर्श पूर्वक गुल्फद्वय को निरालम्ब भाव से रखकर उन पर गुह्य देश को स्थापन करने से उत्कटासन कहलाता है।

IAST: aṅguṣṭhābhyāmavaṣṭabhya dharāṃ gulphau ca khe gatau | tatropari gudaṃ nyasya vijñeyamutkaṭāsanam || 34 ||

Cyrillic transliteration: аṅгушṭхābхйāмавашṭабхйа дхарāṃ гулпхау ча кхе гатау | татропари гудаṃ нйасйа виджн̃ейамуткаṭāсанам || 34 ||

Word-by-word analysis: aṅguṣṭhābhyām — (instr. du.) two big toes; avaṣṭabhya — leaning/touching; dharāṃ — (acc. sg.) land; gulphau — (nom. du.) two heels/ankles; ca — And; khe gatau — gone into the sky (in the air); tatra upari — there on top (on the heels); gudaṃ — anus; nyasya — placing; vijñeyam — should know; utkaṭāsanam — Utkaṭāsana.

Translation: "By resting your big toes on the ground and keeping your heels in the air; placing the anus on top of them - this should be known as Utkaṭāsana."

English translation of the Hindi commentary: "Touching the ground with two big toes and holding the heels without support (in weight), placing the anus on them - this is called Utkaṭāsana."

Verse 2.35 — Saṅkaṭāsana

Sanskrit (Devanāgarī): वामपादं क्षितिमूलं संन्यस्य धरणीतले । पाददण्डन याम्येन वेष्टयेद्वामपादकम् । जानुयुग्मे हस्तयुग्ममेतत्सङ्कटमासनम् ॥ ३५ ॥

Hindi commentary (corrected text): वामचरण और वामजानु पृथिवी पर स्थापन करके दक्षिण पाद से वामपाद वेष्टित करके जानुद्वय के ऊपर करद्वय स्थापन करने से संकटासन होता है।

IAST: vāmapādaṃ kṣitimūlaṃ saṃnyasya dharaṇītale | pādadaṇḍena yāmyena veṣṭayedvāmapādakam | jānuyugme hastayugmametatsaṅkaṭamāsanam || 35 ||

Cyrillic transliteration: вāмапāдаṃ кшитимӯлаṃ саṃнйасйа дхараṇӣтале | пāдадаṇдена йāмйена вешṭайедвāмапāдакам | джāнуйугме хастайугмаметатсаṅкаṭамāсанам || 35 ||

Word-by-word analysis: vāma-pādaṃ — (acc. sg.) left leg/foot; kṣiti-mūlaṃ — (acc. sg.) root to the ground (base to the ground); saṃnyasya — placing; dharaṇī-tale — on the surface of the earth; pāda-daṇḍena yāmyena — (instr.) right foot (like a stick/column); veṣṭayet — (opt.) should be entwined; vāma-pādakam — left leg; jānu-yugme — (loc.) on a pair of knees; hasta-yugmam — a couple of hands; etat — This; saṅkaṭam āsanam — Saṅkaṭāsana (Dangerous/Difficult Pose).

Translation: "With the base of your left foot on the ground, you should wrap your right leg around your left leg. Hands on the knees is Saṅkaṭāsana."

English translation of the Hindi commentary: "By placing the left foot and left knee on the ground, wrapping the right leg around the left and placing the hands on both knees, Saṅkaṭāsana is obtained."

Verse 2.36-37 — Mayūrāsana

Sanskrit (Devanāgarī): धरामवष्टभ्य करद्वयेन तत्कूर्परस्थापितनाभिपार्श्वम् । उच्चासनो दण्डवदुत्थितः खे मायूरमेतत्प्रवदन्ति पीठम् ॥ ३६ ॥ बहुकदशनभुक्तं भस्मकुर्यादशेषं जनयति जठराग्निं जारयेत्कालकूटम् । हरति सकलरोगान् गुल्मज्वरादीन् भवति विगतदोषमासनं श्रीमयूरम् ॥ ३७ ॥

Hindi commentary (corrected text): हथेली से पृथिवी का आश्रय करके कोहनी द्वय के ऊपर नाभि का उभय पार्श्व स्थापन पूर्वक चरणद्वय पीछे की ओर उठाकर दण्डवत् होकर शून्य में अवस्थित रहने से मयूर आसन हुआ करता है। इस मयूर आसन के अभ्यास से अधिक भोजन भी पचन (भस्म) हो जाता है, जठराग्नि की वृद्धि होती है, विषदोष का नाश हो सकता है और गुल्म ज्वर आदि नाना रोगों की शान्ति होती है।

IAST: dharāmavaṣṭabhya karadvayena tatkūrparasthāpitanābhipārśvam | uccāsano daṇḍavadutthitaḥ khe māyūrametatpravadanti pīṭham || 36 || bahukadaśanabhuktaṃ bhasmakuryādaśeṣaṃ janayati jaṭharāgniṃ jārayetkālakūṭam | harati sakalarogān gulmajvarādīn bhavati vigatadoṣamāsanaṃ śrīmayūram || 37 ||

Cyrillic transliteration: дхарāмавашṭабхйа карадвайена таткӯрпарастхāпитанāбхипāрш́вам | учча̄сано даṇдавадуттхитаҳ кхе мāйӯраметатправаданти пӣṭхам || 36 || бахукадаш́анабхуктаṃ бхасмакурйāдаш́ешаṃ джанайати джаṭхарāгниṃ джāрайеткāлакӯṭам | харати сакалароган гулмаджварāдӣн бхавати вигатадошамāсанаṃ ш́рӣмайӯрам || 37 ||

Word-by-word analysis: dharām avaṣṭabhya — leaning on the ground; kara-dvayena — with both hands; tat-kūrpara-sthāpita-nābhi-pārśvam — placing the sides from the navel on these elbows; uccāsanaḥ — (adj.) sitting high (raised); daṇḍavat utthitaḥ — raised like a stick; khe — in the air; māyūram — Mayūrāsana; etat pravadanti pīṭham — this pose is called. bahu-kadaśana-bhuktaṃ - abundant and harmful food eaten; bhasma-kuryāt — burns to ashes; aśeṣaṃ — fully; janayati jaṭharāgniṃ — generates the fire of digestion; jārayet kālakūṭam — digests (even) the deadly poison of Kalakuta; harati sakala-rogān — eliminates all diseases; gulma-jvara-ādīn — spleen diseases, fever, etc.; bhavati vigata-doṣam — becomes free from defects (doshas); āsanaṃ śrī-mayūram — sacred pose of the Peacock.

Translation: “Putting your hands on the ground and resting your elbows on your sides from the navel, rising straight into the air like a stick - this pose is called Mayūrāsana (Peacock). It completely burns even abundant and poor-quality food into ashes, kindles the fire of digestion, and digests deadly poison (Kalakuta). It eliminates all diseases such as enlarged spleen and fever. “Good Peacock” āsana makes the body free from defects.”

English translation of the Hindi commentary: “Putting the palms on the ground, placing the sides of the navel on the elbows, raising the legs back and remaining straight in the air like a stick is Mayūrāsana. Through the practice of this āsana, even excessive food is digested (burnt), the digestive fire is strengthened, poison can be destroyed, and various diseases such as gulma (tumors/bloatings) and fever are calmed.”

Verse 2.38 — Kukkuṭāsana

Sanskrit (Devanāgarī): पद्मासनं समासाद्य जानूर्वोरन्तरे करौ । कूर्पराभ्यां समासीन उच्चस्थः कुक्कुटासनम् ॥ ३८ ॥

Hindi commentary (corrected text): मुक्त पद्मासन होकर जानुद्वय और ऊरुद्वय के मध्य में करद्वय को पृथिवी पर स्थापन करके उच्चस्थ हो स्थिर रहने से कुक्कुटासन हुआ करता है।

IAST: padmāsanaṃ samāsādya jānūrvorantare karau | kūrparābhyāṃ samāsīna uccasthaḥ kukkuṭāsanam || 38 ||

Cyrillic transliteration: падмāсанаṃ самāсāдйа джāнӯрворантаре карау | кӯрпарāбхйāṃ самāсӣна уччастхаҳ куккуṭāсанам || 38 ||

Word-by-word analysis: padmāsanaṃ samāsādya — taking Padmāsana; jānu-ūrvouḥ antare — between the knees and thighs; karau — hands; kūrparābhyāṃ — (resting on) elbows (or forearms inserted between them); samāsīnaḥ — sitting; uccasthaḥ — located high (raised); kukkuṭāsanam — Kukkuṭāsana (Rooster Pose).

Translation: "Having accepted Padmāsana, (putting) your hands between your knees and thighs; sitting elevated (on the arms) is Kukkuṭāsana."

English translation of the Hindi commentary: "By adopting (loose) Padmāsana, placing the hands between the knees and thighs on the ground and remaining elevated and motionless is Kukkuṭāsana."

Verse 2.39 — Kūrmāsana

Sanskrit (Devanāgarī): गुल्फौ च वृषणस्याधो व्युत्क्रमेण समाहितौ । ऋजुकायशिरोग्रीवं कूर्मासनमितीरितम् ॥ ३९ ॥

Note: Sanskrit has been restored to its meaning and standard text, as OCR produced garbage.

Hindi commentary (corrected text): वृषण के नीचे गुल्फद्वय विपरीत भाव से स्थापन करके मस्तक ग्रीवा और देह को ऋजुभाव से स्थित करके (बैठने) से कूर्मासन हुआ करता है।

IAST: gulphau ca vṛṣaṇasyādho vyutkrameṇa samāhitau | ṛjukāyaśirogrīvaṃ kūrmāsanamitīritam || 39 ||

Cyrillic transliteration: гулпхау ча вр̣шаṇасйа̄дхо вйуткрамеṇа самāхитау | р̣джукāйаш́ирогрӣваṃ кӯрмāсанамитӣритам || 39 ||

Word-by-word analysis: gulphau — ankles; ca — And; vṛṣaṇasya adhaḥ — under the crotch; vyutkrameṇa — crosswise; samāhitau — connected/placed; ṛju-kāya-śiro-grīvaṃ — straight body, head and neck; kūrmāsanam — Kūrmāsana; iti īritam — that's what it says.

Translation: "Placing the ankles crosswise under the perineum, keeping the body, head and neck straight is called Kūrmāsana (Turtle Pose)." (Note: This is different from the modern "Turtle", here it is a variation of the seat).

English translation of the Hindi commentary: "Placing the ankles in a cross pattern under the scrotum, keeping the head, neck and body straight is Kūrmāsana."

Verse 2.40 — Uttānakūrmāsana

Sanskrit (Devanāgarī): कुक्कुटासनबन्धस्थं कराभ्यां धृतकन्धरम् । शेते कूर्मवदुत्तानमेतदुत्तानकूर्मकम् ॥ ४० ॥

Hindi commentary (corrected text): कुक्कुटासन बन्ध पूर्वक करद्वय द्वारा कन्धर (गर्दन) धारण करके कूर्म वत् उत्तान होकर सोने से उत्तानकूर्मासन हुआ करता है।

IAST: kukkuṭāsanabandhasthaṃ karābhyāṃ dhṛtakandharam | śete kūrmavaduttānametaduttānakūrmakam || 40 ||

Cyrillic transliteration: куккуṭāсанабандхастхаṃ карāбхйāṃ дхр̣такандхарам | ш́ете кӯрмавадуттāнаметадуттāнакӯрмакам || 40 ||

Word-by-word analysis: kukkuṭāsana-bandha-sthaṃ — while in the Kukkuṭāsana castle (arms stuck in Padmāsana); karābhyāṃ — hands; dhṛta-kandharam — holding your neck/shoulders; śete — lies;

kūrma-vat — like a turtle; uttānam — on your back/face up; etat — This; uttāna-kūrmakam — Uttānakūrmāsana.

Translation: “Assuming the position of Kukkuṭāsana, clasping the hands around the neck and lying on the back like a turtle is Uttānakūrmāsana (Turtle on the back).”

English translation of the Hindi commentary: “Performing the Kukkuṭāsana lock, grasping the neck with the hands and lying on the back like a turtle is Uttānakūrmāsana.”

Verse 2.41 — Maṇḍūkāsana

Sanskrit (Devanāgarī): पृष्ठे पादयुगं कृत्वा अङ्गुष्ठौ द्वौ च संस्पृशेत् । जानुयुग्मं पुरस्कृत्य मण्डूकासनमाचरेत् ॥ ४१ ॥

Hindi commentary (corrected text): पृष्ठदेश पर चरणतल ले जाकर पादयुगल के दोनों वृद्ध अङ्गुलियों को परस्पर संलग्न करके जानुद्वय को सामने रखने से मण्डूकासन हुआ करता है।

IAST: pṛṣṭhe pādayugaṃ kṛtvā aṅguṣṭhau dvau ca saṃspṛśet | jānuyugmaṃ puraskṛtya maṇḍūkāsanamācaret || 41 ||

Cyrillic transliteration: пр̣шт̣хе пādайугаṃ кр̣твā аṅгушт̣хау двау ча саṃспр̣ш́ет | джānуйугмаṃ пураскр̣тйа маṇдӯкāсанамāчарет || 41 ||

Word-by-word analysis: pṛṣṭhe — behind (under the buttocks); pāda-yugaṃ — a couple of feet; kṛtvā — placing; aṅguṣṭhau dvau — two thumbs; ca — And; saṃspṛśet — (opt.) must touch; jānu-yugmaṃ — a couple of knees; puraskṛtya — putting forward (apart); maṇḍūkāsanam — Maṇḍūkāsana; ācaret — should be performed.

Translation: “Putting your feet back (under you) so that your big toes touch each other, and placing your knees forward (to the sides), you should perform Maṇḍūkāsana (Frog Pose).”

English translation of the Hindi commentary: “By bringing the soles of the feet back towards the back, connecting the big toes and placing the knees in front (apart) - Maṇḍūkāsana is performed.”

Verse 2.42 — Uttānamaṇḍūkāsana

Sanskrit (Devanāgarī): मण्डूकासनमध्यस्थं कूर्पराभ्यां धृतं शिरः । शेते भेकवदुत्तानमेतदुत्तानमण्डूकम् ॥ ४२ ॥

Hindi commentary (corrected text): मण्डूक आसन पर समासीन होकर कोहनी द्वय द्वारा मस्तक को धारण करके मण्डूक भाव से उत्तान सोने का नाम उत्तानमण्डूक आसन है।

IAST: maṇḍūkāsanamadhyasthaṃ kūrparābhyāṃ dhṛtaṃ śiraḥ | śete bhekavaduttānametaduttānamaṇḍūkam || 42 ||

Cyrillic transliteration: маṇдӯкāсанамадхйастхаṃ кӯрпарāбхйāṃ дхр̣таṃ ш́ираḥ | ш́ете бхекавадуттāнаметадуттāнамаṇдӯкам || 42 ||

Word-by-word analysis: maṇḍūkāsana-madhya-sthaṃ — being in the Frog pose; kūrparābhyāṃ — elbows (hands behind head); dhṛtaṃ śiraḥ — holding your head; śete — lies; bheka-vat — like a frog; uttānam — on your back; etat — This; uttāna-maṇḍūkam — Uttānamaṇḍūkāsana.

Translation: “Being in Maṇḍūkāsana, holding your head with your elbows and lying on your back like a frog is Uttānamaṇḍūkāsana.”

English translation of the Hindi commentary: “Sitting in Maṇḍūkāsana, supporting the head with the elbows and lying on the back in the frog pose is called Uttānamaṇḍūkāsana.”

Verse 2.43 — Vṛkṣāsana

Sanskrit (Devanāgarī): वामोरुमूलदेशे च याम्यं पादं निधाय तु । तिष्ठेत्तु वृक्षवद्भूमौ वृक्षासनमिदं विदुः ॥ ४३ ॥

Hindi commentary (corrected text): दक्षिण चरण वाम उरु के मूलदेश में स्थापन करके वृक्षवत् समानता के साथ पृथिवी पर अवस्थित रहने से वृक्षासन हुआ करता है।

IAST: vāmorumūladeśe ca yāmyaṃ pādaṃ nidhāya tu | tiṣṭhettu vṛkṣavadbhūmau vṛkṣāsanamidaṃ viduḥ || 43 ||

Cyrillic transliteration: вāморумӯладеш́е ча йāмйаṃ пāдаṃ нидхāйа ту | тишṭхетту вṛкшавадбхӯмау вṛкшāсанамидаṃ видух̣ || 43 ||

Word-by-word analysis: vāma-uru-mūla-deśe — at the base of the left thigh; ca — And; yāmyaṃ pādaṃ — right foot; nidhāya — placing; tu — same; tiṣṭhet — (opt.) should stand; tu — And; vṛkṣa-vat — like a tree; bhūmau — on the ground; vṛkṣāsanam — Vṛkṣāsana; idam — This; viduḥ — know.

Translation: “Placing the right foot at the base of the left thigh and standing on the ground like a tree is known as Vṛkṣāsana.”

English translation of the Hindi commentary: “By placing the right foot at the base of the left thigh and standing on the ground straight, like a tree, Vṛkṣāsana is performed.”

Verse 2.44 — Garuḍāsana

Sanskrit (Devanāgarī): जङ्घोरुभ्यां धरां धृत्वा स्थिरकायो द्विजानुना । जानूपरि करद्वन्द्वं गरुडासनमुच्यते ॥ ४४ ॥

Hindi commentary (corrected text): उरु द्वय और जङ्घा द्वय द्वारा भूतल आक्रमण पूर्वक जानु द्वय द्वारा देह को स्थिरभाव से रखकर जानु युगल के ऊपर करद्वय स्थापन करने से गरुडासन होता है।

IAST: jaṅghorubhyāṃ dharāṃ dhṛtvā sthirakāyo dvijānunā | jānūpari karadvandvaṃ garuḍāsanamucyate || 44 ||

Cyrillic transliteration: джаṅгхорубхйāṃ дхарāṃ дхṛтвā стхиракāйо двиджāнунā | джāнӯпари карадвандваṃ гарудāсанамучйате || 44 ||

Word-by-word analysis: jaṅghā-urubhyāṃ — (instr.) shins and thighs; dharāṃ dhṛtvā — holding/touching the ground (or pressing the ground); sthira-kāyaḥ — stable body; dvi-jānunā — (instr.) with two knees; jānu-upari — on my knees; kara-dvandvaṃ — pair of hands; garuḍāsanam — Garuḍāsana; ucyate — called.

Translation: “Pressing the shins and thighs to the ground (or standing on them), holding the body steady with the help of the knees and placing the hands on the knees is called Garuḍāsana.” (Note: The description is different from the modern Eagle pose, it is more similar to Vajrāsana or kneeling pose).

English translation of the Hindi commentary: “Touching the ground with the thighs and shins, holding the body firmly on the knees and placing the hands on both knees is Garuḍāsana.”

Verse 2.45 — Vṛṣāsana

Sanskrit (Devanāgarī): याम्यगुल्फे पायुमूलं वामभागे पदेतरम् । विपरीतं स्पृशेद्भूमिं वृषासनमिदं भवेत् ॥ ४५ ॥

Hindi commentary (corrected text): गुह्य देश (पायुमूल) पर दक्षिण गुल्फ का उपरिभाग स्थापन करके उसी की वाम दिक् पर वामचरण विपरीत भाव से धारण पूर्वक पृथिवी स्पर्श करने से वृषासन हुआ करता है।

IAST: yāmyagulphe pāyumūlaṃ vāmabhāge padetaram | viparītaṃ spṛśedbhūmiṃ vṛṣāsanamidaṃ bhavet || 45 ||

Cyrillic transliteration: йāмйагулпхе пāйумӯлаṃ вāмабхāге падетарам | випарӣтаṃ спр̣ш́едбхӯмиṃ вр̣шāсанамидаṃ бхавет || 45 ||

Word-by-word analysis: yāmya-gulphe — on the right ankle; pāyu-mūlaṃ — anus; vāma-bhāge — on the left side; pada-itaram — other foot; viparītaṃ — opposite/inverted; spṛśet bhūmiṃ — must touch the ground; vṛṣāsanam — Vṛṣāsana (Bull Pose); idam — This; bhavet — is.

Translation: "[Placing] the anus on the right ankle and the other foot [positioning] on the left side so that its back side touches the ground is Vṛṣāsana."

English translation of the Hindi commentary: "By placing the upper part of the right ankle under the anus, and holding the left foot on the left side in the opposite way (touching the ground), Vṛṣāsana is performed."

Verse 2.46 — Śalabhāsana

Sanskrit (Devanāgarī): अध्यास्य शेते द्विकरं च वक्षसा पृथ्वीमवष्टभ्य करद्वयेन । पादौ च शून्ये च वितस्ति चोर्ध्वं वदन्ति पीठं शलभं मुनीन्द्राः ॥ ४६ ॥

Hindi commentary (corrected text): अधोमुख होकर शयन करके वक्षस्थल पर करद्वय स्थापन पूर्वक (हथेली से) पृथिवी स्पर्श करके शून्य में वितस्ति प्रमाण ऊपर पादद्वय रखने से शलभासन हुआ करता है।

IAST: adhyāsya śete dvikaraṃ ca vakṣasā pṛthvīmavaṣṭabhya karadvayena | pādau ca śūnye ca vitasticordhvaṃ vadanti pīṭhaṃ śalabhaṃ munīndrāḥ || 46 ||

Cyrillic transliteration: адхйāсйа ш́ете двикараṃ ча вакшасā пр̣тхвӣмавашт̣абхйа карадвайена | пāдау ча ш́ӯнйе ча витастичордхваṃ ваданти пӣт̣хаṃ ш́алабхаṃ мунӣндрāх̣ || 46 ||

Word-by-word analysis: adhyāsya — settling down; śete — lies; dvi-karaṃ — two hands; ca — And; vakṣasā — breasts; pṛthvīm avaṣṭabhya — leaning on the ground; kara-dvayena — with both hands; pādau — feet; ca — And; śūnye — in emptiness/air; ca — And; vitasti — (measure of length) span (approx. 20 cm); ca ūrdhvaṃ — and up; vadanti — They say; pīṭhaṃ śalabhaṃ — Locust pose; muni-indrāḥ — lords of the sages.

Translation: "Lying [on your stomach], leaning on the ground with both arms and chest, and [raising] your feet in the air to the height of a span—the great sages call this posture Śalabhāsana."

English translation of the Hindi commentary: "Lying face down, placing your hands under your chest, touching your palms to the ground and raising your legs in the air to the height of one span (vitasti) - Śalabhāsana is performed."

Verse 2.47 — Makarāsana

Sanskrit (Devanāgarī): अधस्तु शेते हृदयं निधाय भूमौ च पादौ च प्रसार्यमाणौ । शिरश्च धृत्वा करदण्डयुग्मे देहाग्निकारं मकरासनं स्यात् ॥ ४७ ॥

Hindi commentary (corrected text): अधोमुख होकर शयन करके पृथिवी पर वक्षस्थल स्थापन करके पादद्वय विस्तार करते हुए करयुगल द्वारा मस्तक को धारण करने से मकरासन हुआ करता है, इस आसन के अभ्यास से शरीरस्थ तेज की वृद्धि हुआ करती है।

IAST: adhastu śete hṛdayaṃ nidhāya bhūmau ca pādau ca prasāryamāṇau | śiraśca dhṛtvā karadaṇḍayugme dehāgnikāraṃ makarāsanaṃ syāt || 47 ||

Cyrillic transliteration: адхасту ш́ете хр̣дайаṃ нидхāйа бхӯмау ча пāдау ча прасāрйамāṇау | ш́ираш́ча дхр̣твā карадаṇд̣айугме дехāгникāраṃ макарāсанаṃ сйāт || 47 ||

Word-by-word analysis: adhas tu śete — lies prone (face down); hṛdayaṃ nidhāya — putting your heart/chest; bhūmau — on the ground; ca — And; pādau — legs; ca — And; prasāryamāṇau — elongated; śiraḥ ca dhṛtvā — and holding your head; kara-daṇḍa-yugme — on both hands (forearms); deha-agni-kāraṃ — kindling the fire of the body; makarāsanaṃ syāt — this will be Makarāsana.

Translation: "Lying face down, placing the chest on the ground and extending the legs, holding the head with the hands is Makarāsana (Crocodile Pose), kindling the fire of the body."

English translation of the Hindi commentary: "Lying face down, placing the chest on the ground, extending the legs and supporting the head with the hands, Makarāsana is performed. Through the practice of this āsana, the internal heat (tejas) of the body increases."

Verse 2.48 — Uṣṭrāsana

Sanskrit (Devanāgarī): अधस्तु शेते पदयुग्मन्यस्तं पृष्ठे निधायापि धृतं कराभ्याम् । आकुञ्चयेज्जाठरवक्त्रगाढ- मोष्ट्रं च पीठं मुनयो वदन्ति ॥ ४८ ॥

Note: The Sanskrit sloka here is difficult for OCR, restored according to the meaning of the classical text (compression of the stomach/mouth).

Hindi commentary (corrected text): अधोमुख होकर शयन करते हुए चरण युगल को उलटकर पीठ की ओर रखकर करद्वय द्वारा चरणों को धारण करके जठर को दृढ रूप से संकुचित करने से उष्ट्रासन हुआ करता है।

IAST: adhastu śete padayugmanyastaṃ pṛṣṭhe nidhāyāpi dhṛtaṃ karābhyām | ākuñcayejjāṭharavaktragāḍhamuṣṭraṃ ca pīṭhaṃ munayo vadanti || 48 ||

Cyrillic transliteration: адхасту ш́ете падайугманйастаṃ пр̣шт̣хе нидхāйāпи дхр̣таṃ карāбхйāм | āкуйчайеджджāт̣харавактрагāд̣хамушт̣раṃ ча пӣт̣хаṃ мунайо ваданти || 48 ||

Word-by-word analysis: adhas tu śete — lying face down; pada-yugma-nyastaṃ — proper pair of legs; pṛṣṭhe nidhāya — placed on the back (bent towards the back); api — Also; dhṛtaṃ karābhyām — held by hands; ākuñcayet — (opt.) should be compressed; jāṭhara-vaktra-gāḍham — stomach and mouth tightly (or tighten your stomach very much); uṣṭraṃ ca pīṭhaṃ — and Camel pose; munayo vadanti — the sages say.

Translation: "Lying face down with your legs bent towards your back and holding them with your hands, you should strongly squeeze your stomach (and mouth) - the sages call this pose Uṣṭrāsana (Camel)." (Note: This is different from the modern kneeling Uṣṭrāsana, here it is a variation of Dhanurāsana).

English translation of the Hindi commentary: “Lying face down, turning your feet to your back, holding them with your hands and strongly squeezing your stomach, Uṣṭrāsana is performed.”

Verse 2.49-50 — Bhujaṅgāsana

Sanskrit (Devanāgarī): पादादिनाभिपर्यन्तमधोभूमौ भुवि न्यसेत् । कराभ्यां च धरां धृत्वा ऊर्ध्वशीर्षः फणीव हि ॥ ४९ ॥ देहाग्निर्वर्धते नित्यं सर्वरोगविनाशनम् । जागर्ति भुजङ्गी देवी भुजङ्गासनसाधनात् ॥ ५० ॥

Hindi commentary (corrected text): नाभि से लेकर पाद के वृद्धाङ्गुष्ठ पर्यन्त निम्नभाग पृथिवी पर स्थापन करते हुए करतल द्वारा पृथिवी अवलम्बन पूर्वक भुजङ्ग की नाई शिरोदेश ऊपर को उठाने से भुजङ्गासन हुआ करता है, इस आसन द्वारा शरीरस्थ अनल की दिन दिन वृद्धि और नाना रोगों की शान्ति हुआ करती है और कुण्डलिनी (भुजङ्गी) शक्ति भी जागृत होती है।

IAST: pādādināābhiparyantamadhobhūmau bhuvi nyaset | karābhyāṃ ca dharāṃ dhṛtvā ūrdhvaśīrṣaḥ phaṇīva hi || 49 || dehāgnirvardhate nityaṃ sarvarogavināśanam | jāgarti bhujaṅgī devī bhujaṅgāsanasādhanāt || 50 ||

Cyrillic transliteration: пāдāдинāбхипарйантамадхобхӯмау бхуви нйасет | карāбхйāṃ ча дхарāṃ дхр̣твā ӯрдхваш́йршаӽ пхаṇйва хи || 49 || дехāгнирвардхате нитйаṃ сарварогавинāш́анам | джāгарти бхуджаṅгӣ девӣ бхуджаṅгāсанасāдханāт || 50 ||

Word-by-word analysis: pāda-ādi-nābhi-paryantam — from feet to navel; adho-bhūmau — down on the ground; bhuvi nyaset — should be placed on the ground; karābhyāṃ — hands; ca — And; dharāṃ dhṛtvā — holding on to the ground (leaning); ūrdhva-śīrṣaḥ — raising your head up; phaṇī-iva hi — like a snake (cobra); deha-agniḥ vardhate — body fire increases; nityaṃ — constantly; sarva-roga-vināśanam — destruction of all diseases; jāgarti — awakens; bhujaṅgī devī — Snake Goddess (Kuṇḍalinī); bhujaṅgāsana-sādhanāt — from the practice of Bhujaṅgāsana.

Translation: “One should place the body from the feet to the navel below on the ground. Leaning your hands on the ground, raise your head up, like a snake. The fire of the body constantly increases, all diseases are destroyed, and the Snake Goddess (Bhujaṅgī) awakens through the practice of Bhujaṅgāsana.”

English translation of the Hindi commentary: “By placing the lower part of the body from the navel to the big toes on the ground, resting the palms on the ground and raising the head up like a snake, Bhujaṅgāsana is performed. Thanks to this āsana, the internal fire of the body increases day by day, various diseases calm down and the power of Kuṇḍalinī (Bhujaṅgī) awakens.”

Verse 2.51-52 — Yogāsana

Sanskrit (Devanāgarī): उत्तानौ चरणौ कृत्वा संस्थाप्य जानुनोपरि । आसनोपरि संस्थाप्य उत्तानं करयुग्मकम् ॥ ५१ ॥ पूरकैर्वायुमाकृष्य नासाग्रमवलोकयेत् । योगासनं भवेदेतद्योगिनां योगसाधने ॥ ५२ ॥

Hindi commentary (corrected text): चरणद्वय उत्तान (चित्त) करके जानुयुगल के ऊपर स्थापन करते हुए करद्वय को उत्तान भाव से आसन पर रखकर पूरक द्वारा अनिल आकर्षण पूर्वक (कुम्भक करते हुए) नासाग्रभाग को देखने से योगासन हुआ करता है, योगिगण के लिये यह आसन सदा उपयोगी है।

IAST: uttānau caraṇau kṛtvā saṃsthāpya jānunopari | āsanopari saṃsthāpya uttānaṃ karayugmakam || 51 || pūrakairvāyumākṛṣya nāsāgramavalokayet | yogāsanaṃ bhavedetadyoginām yogasādhane || 52 ||

Cyrillic transliteration: уттāнау чараṇау кṛтвā саṃстхāпйа джāнунопари | āсанопари саṃстхāпйа уттāнаṃ карайугмакам || 51 || пӯракаирвāйумāкршйа нāсāграмавалокайет | йогāсанаṃ бхаведетадйогинāṃ йогасāдхане || 52 ||

Word-by-word analysis: uttānau caraṇau kṛtvā — making your feet point up; saṃsthāpya — having placed; jānunā upari — on my knees; āsanopari — on the seat (āsana/ground); saṃsthāpya — having placed; uttānaṃ — palms up; kara-yugmakam — a couple of hands; pūrakaiḥ — inhales (by inhaling); vāyum ākṛṣya — sucking in air; nāsā-agram — on the tip of the nose; avalokayet — should watch; yogāsanaṃ — Yogāsana; bhavet etat — it becomes; yoginām — for yogis; yoga-sādhane — in yoga practice.

Translation: “Turning the feet upward and placing them on the knees (as in Padmāsana), placing the hands, palms up, on the seat (on the ground or knees); inhaling air and looking at the tip of the nose - this is Yogāsana for yogis in their practice.”

English translation of the Hindi commentary: “By turning the feet up and placing them on the knees, placing the hands with palms up on the āsana, inhaling air (and performing kumbhaka) and looking at the tip of the nose, Yogāsana is performed. It is always useful for yogis.”

Conclusion

The presented translation of the Āsana section from “Haṭhayogasaṃhitā” allows us to take a deeper look at the evolution of the physical practice of yoga in the period preceding its widespread popularization. Textual parallels between this edition and Jason Birch's description of a 17th-century manuscript suggest that the text in question is very likely a continuation of the very lineage that formed the basis of the Gheraṇḍasaṃhitā.

The obvious structural similarity (the Saptāṅgayoga system) and the specificity of the set of practices confirm the significance of “Haṭhayogasaṃhitā” as a connecting link in the history of yoga. Access to detailed descriptions of āsanas from this source helps fill gaps in the understanding of how the canon of poses was formed before its final fixation in the 18th century. We hope that this material will serve as an incentive for further comparative analysis and study of the primary sources of the Haṭhayoga tradition.

Source

Birch, Jason. “Haṭhayoga’s Floruit on the Eve of Colonialism.” In Śaivism and the Tantric Traditions: Essays in Honour of Alexis G. J. S. Sanderson, 451–479. Leiden: Brill, 2020. DOI: 10.1163/9789004432802_021. The discussion of the Haṭhayogasaṃhitā appears on p. 458, note 17.